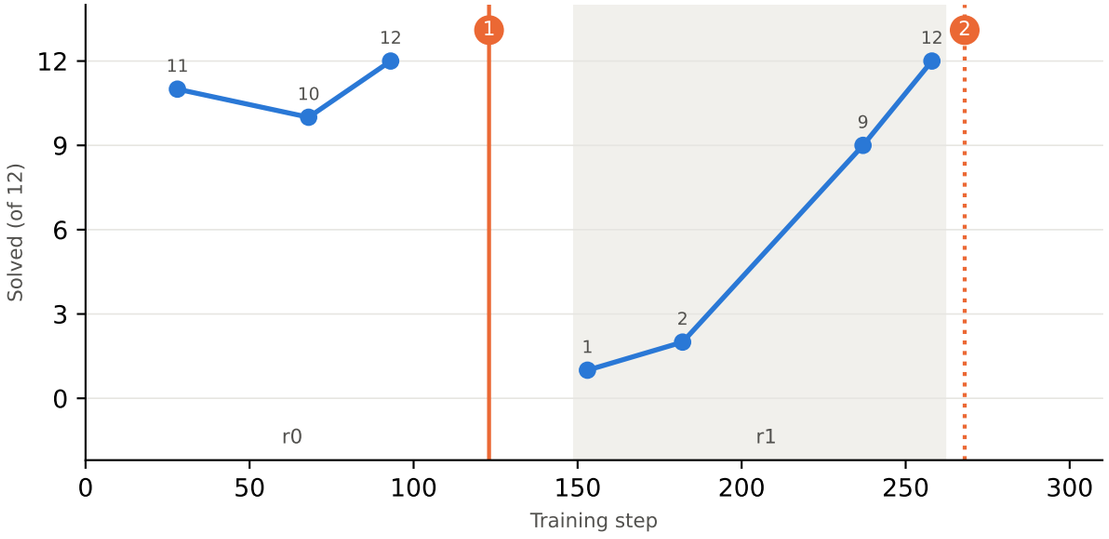
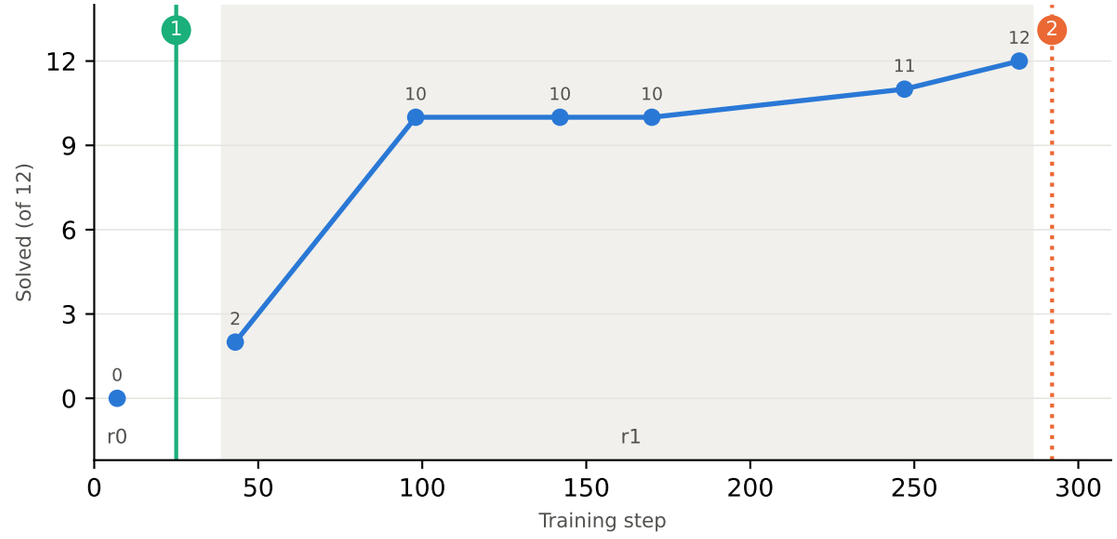
(a) Harder rewrite forces a new skill
nginx TLS load balancer



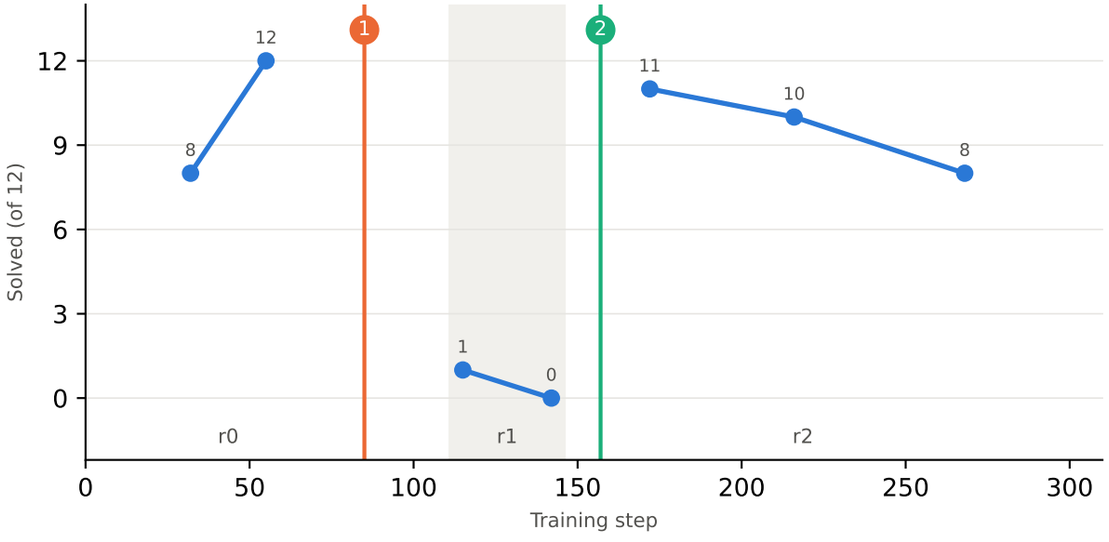
1. [harder] Certificate must pass hostname verification (pinned urllib3 2.0 drops the CN fallback); old solutions used CN-only certs + curl -k.
2. [harder] Also require TLS 1.3 clients (accepted after the task's last trained group).

(b) Easier rewrite unblocks a 0/12 task
RLE codec repair



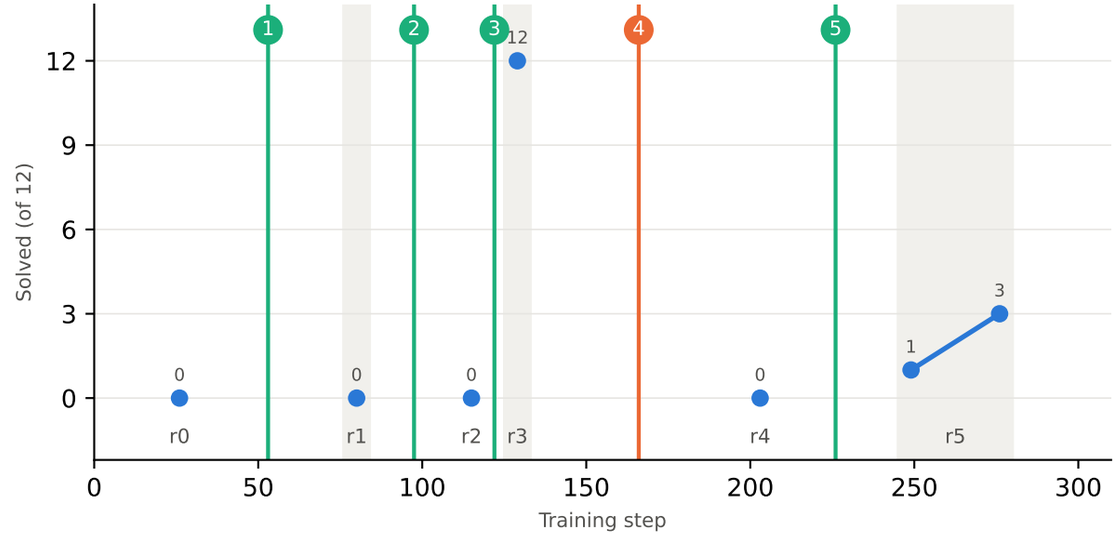
1. [easier] Fix the self-contradictory run-length comment in rle.h (every attempt built an off-by-one codec); no code or patch given.
2. [harder] Harder follow-up (accepted after the task's last trained group).

(c) Harder overshoots, easier pulls back
C memory-pool allocator



1. [harder] Add C11 fundamental-alignment requirement for every returned block.
2. [easier] Remove the added alignment check (8/12 had fixed the original bug and failed only this).

(d) Failure mode: easier rewrites hand over the core work
Python/C polyglot



1. [easier] Narrow N from 0-100 to 0-5.
2. [easier] Require only N=0; hint at C preprocessor vs Python strings.
3. [easier] Ship the working C implementation as a header (core work handed over).
4. [harder] Harder rewrite.
5. [easier] Ship only a C output helper; hint the wrapper structure.